

The GLP-1 Holiday Survival Guide

Parties, travel, and the family dinner table — from a PA who is also doing this.

FREE · NO EMAIL · NOTHING TO SIGN UP FOR

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

Don't "save up" for the party

The instinct is to skip breakfast and lunch so you have room at dinner. **On a GLP-1 that backfires harder than it does for anyone else.**

Here is why. These medications work partly by **slowing how fast your stomach empties**. That is on the label, it is the mechanism, and it does not care what your plan for the evening was. Arrive empty and hungry, eat a large plate quickly, and you have put a lot of food into a stomach that is already emptying slowly. **That is where the miserable, too-full, up-half-the-night feeling comes from.** It is not a willpower failure. It is physics.

What I do instead

- **Eat protein earlier in the day.** Not less food. Normal food, earlier.
- **Protein first on the plate**, then vegetables, then the rest. Same meal, different order.
- **Smaller first plate. Go back if you want more.** You almost never do, and you have not committed yourself in advance.
- **Slow down between bites.** Fullness arrives late on these medications. If you eat at your old speed, you will pass the signal before you feel it.

Under-eating for days around a holiday is its own problem. Very low intake while losing weight is associated with losing muscle along with fat. Eat the meals.

Alcohol, and the conversation nobody warns you about

ALCOHOL

Talk to your provider about alcohol on your specific medication — that one is genuinely individual and I am not going to pretend otherwise. What I can tell you is what to be ready for.

- **It can hit differently and faster than you remember.** Slower stomach emptying, often much less food on board, and frequently less total intake than the version of you who set your tolerance.
- **Hydrate first and between.** Dehydration and nausea stack, and both are already more likely.
- **Sugary mixers on a mostly-empty stomach** are the worst combination for how you will feel an hour later.
- **If you take anything else for blood sugar,** this is a provider conversation before the party, not during it.

“OH COME ON, IT’S CHRISTMAS.”

You will get this. Possibly from someone who loves you. **Have one sentence ready so you are not inventing it while six people watch.**

- “I’m good, I already ate way too much of the good stuff.”
- “I’m pacing myself, this is a marathon.”
- “I’m driving.”
- Or the one that ends it fastest: **“I’m all set, thank you.”** No explanation. No opening.

You do not owe anyone your medical history at a dinner table. Not your in-laws, not the person at the end of the table with Opinions About All Of This, not anyone.

Traveling with your medication

This is the one that ruins a trip if you get it wrong, and it is entirely preventable.

BEFORE YOU LEAVE

- **Never put it in a checked bag.** Carry-on, always. Checked bags get lost, delayed, and left on hot tarmacs.
- **You may bring it through security.** Declare it. Keep it in the original labelled pharmacy packaging — the label is what makes the conversation short.
- **Bring a cold pack and an insulated pouch.** Ask your pharmacy what your specific product needs; storage requirements differ between products and once it has been started.
- **Check the fridge situation before you arrive.** A hotel mini-fridge is not always cold enough and a relative's fridge is a negotiation. Know before you land.
- **Bring more supplies than days.** Needles, alcohol pads, everything. They weigh nothing and you cannot buy them in a strange town on a holiday weekend.

If your injection day lands mid-trip, ask your provider before you go whether to shift it. Do not move your own dose because a party is in the way.

The nausea kit

Have this in the house before you need it. Nothing exotic — everything here is boring on purpose.

THE LIST

- **Ginger** in whatever form you will actually use.
- **Plain crackers or dry toast.** Bland genuinely does help.
- **Cold water and something with electrolytes.** Dehydration makes everything worse.
- **Peppermint tea.**
- **A plan for what you eat the morning after a big meal,** so you are not deciding while you feel bad.

When it is not just nausea. Severe or persistent abdominal pain — especially pain that bores through to your back — vomiting you cannot stop, or signs of dehydration are **provider calls, not ride-it-out situations.** Holiday weekend or not. This is the one page I would not want you to skim.

Where to go from here

The holidays are not a test you pass or fail. They are about nine days spread across six weeks, and the other thirty-something days are the ones that actually make up your life.

ON PROTEIN

Most people I talk to are under-eating protein and have never actually checked. **Ask your provider what a reasonable target looks like for you** — it is a real number and it is individual. My free Protein Floor guide walks through how to think about it, and it is on my Instagram profile with everything else.

ON SUPPLEMENTS, HONESTLY

I take a few. **The evidence for most of them in people who are not actually deficient is thin, and I am not going to tell you otherwise.** I take mine because I have noticed things I like, and that is one person's experience, not a claim that they do anything for you. **Get your labs before you buy anything.** If you want to know specifically what I use, just ask me and I will tell you — there is no public link for that one, so it is a per-person thing.

NOT STARTED YET, AND WONDERING ABOUT THE TIMING

Here is the part people underestimate: **the process takes longer than the decision does.** An appointment, a screening, paperwork if insurance is involved, and an appeal if the first answer is no. **None of that is about your body. It runs on its own clock.**

I'm a physician assistant, and I've been on a GLP-1 myself. My favorite thing is sharing the tips and tricks I've learned on my own GLP-1 journey — mostly the side-effect stuff nobody warns you about.

Come find me: Instagram [@diary_of_the_most_okayest_mom](#) — I answer questions there, and the side-effect stuff nobody warns you about is most of what I post.

Educational only. This is not medical advice and it is not a substitute for your own provider's judgment. Always consult your healthcare provider before starting or stopping any medication or supplement. Results are not guaranteed and individual results may vary.

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